

Why is that?

Because it was a lot less complicated. I was just trading. Now it's running a business.

You're still searching for something.

Yes, there is still a hole there. I'm searching to be satisfied by something. Let me tell you the trouble with trading. There is no career in trading. You are only as good as your last trade, and that is it. You build nothing; you just trade. The day you stop trading, it's gone. So what you have spent doing for X hours every working day of your life has ended, and there is nothing left to show for it, except for money. You have to keep trading because you don't want to stop and look back. Because what have you done? You have built nothing. You have achieved nothing. You get to the end of it and look back and wonder, *What have I accomplished?* I have a very nihilistic view of it, but that is the way I feel. I am still back at that point where I am a 17-year-old trying to decide what I want to do.

But somewhere along the line you went from having joy in this business to feeling unsatisfied. Do you know what caused that transition?

I am not sure, but it is probably from the point that I decided I was going to grow a business instead of just trading.

That almost sounds like it was when you started the hedge fund.

It probably was. The joy ended. Being a trader was fun, and you could walk away. But when you have a business, you can't walk away. So it becomes a prison in some ways, whereas being a trader was very free.

Ironically, you've taken on more business responsibility by becoming a managing member of First New York Securities. Where is the rationale in that?

The rationale is that there is a trade to be done.

The trade is to fix the company?

Yes. The trade is fix the company, be involved for a period, and get much more value for it. It's all very rational. I try to do rational things. Sometimes, you make rational decisions every step of the way and yet